

Readme for “Gridlock: Ethnic diversity in government and the provision of public goods” replication materials

This folder contains the data files and programs necessary to replicate all tables and figures in “Gridlock: Ethnic diversity in government and the provision of public goods”. All analysis is run in Stata. This readme briefly describes the contents of the replication folder.

Data files:

- “Gridlock main data for analysis.dta”
 - This is our main dataset used in the analysis. Each observation is a city-by-year pair. The dataset is the result of merging together data from three sources:
 - (1) California city budget data: This includes our main outcome variables (e.g., spending on public goods). The raw data were purchased from the California Controller’s Office, but are now publicly and freely available to download from the website: bythenumbers.sco.ca.gov. The contents of the data are described in the text.
 - (2) City council election returns: These data provide the election results necessary to identify “close” elections in the regression discontinuity approach. They were downloaded from the California Elections Data Archive (CEDA), and are described fully in the text. Raw data can be downloaded from CEDA’s website: <http://www.csus.edu/isr/Projects/CEDA.html>
 - (3) City council candidate and member ethnicity: As described in the text, we identified the ethnicity of city council candidates and members.
- “Gridlock voting data for analysis.dta”
 - This dataset is used for a subset of analysis where we assess the impact of the election of a non-modal candidate on future electoral outcomes (Table 7). Each observation is a candidate-by-election pair. These data draw from our constructed ethnicity data and the CEDA data on election outcomes.

Do files:

- “Main results.do”: This file draws on dataset “Gridlock main data for analysis.dta” and runs most of the analysis in the paper. Specifically, the file constructs all tables and figures except for Table 6, Table 7, and Figure 2.
- “Table 6.do”: This file draws on dataset “Gridlock main data for analysis.dta” to produce Table 6 results.
- “Table 7.do”: This file draws on dataset “Gridlock voting data for analysis.dta” to produce Table 7 results.
- “Figure 2.do”: This file draws on dataset “Gridlock main data for analysis.dta” to produce Figure 2.

Instructions:

- The analyses require several user-written Stata packages which must be downloaded and installed before running our code. These include: *rdrobust*, *rdplot*, and *DCdensity*.
 - *rdrobust* and *rdplot* can be found and installed by typing “findit rdrobust” in the command window. This leads to a package called “st0366”, which installs both

rdrobust and *rdplot*. These are both necessary for “Main results.do”. These programs are written by Calonico, Cattaneo, and Titiunik.

- *DCdensity* can be downloaded from Justin McCrary’s website (<http://eml.berkeley.edu/~jmccrary/DCdensity/>). Download the “DCdensity.ado” file and save it in the .ado file directory on your computer. This is necessary in order to run “Figure 2.do”.
- All do files are standalone. Thus (after installing necessary programs described in the previous bullet points), they can be run in any order. However, as the bulk of the analysis is in “Main results.do”, we recommend running that do file first. As noted, that creates all Tables and Figures except for Table 6, Table 7, and Figure 2. After running “Main results.do”, “Table 6.do”, “Table 7.do”, and “Figure 2.do” can be run in any order to create the tables and figures indicated in the names of those do files.
- In each do file, users must change the current directory to the location that they have downloaded the files on their computer.